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NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL

WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

Summary of Conclusions for
Meeting of the NSC Principals Committee

DATE: August 22, 1995

LOCATION: White House Situation Room

TIME: 3:30 p.m. - 5:30 p.m.

SUBJECT: Summary of Conclusions of Principals Committee Meeting
on Bosnia ~~(S)~~

PARTICIPANTS:

CHAIR

Anthony Lake

OMB

Alice Rivlin

Keith Bickel

OVP

Leon Fuerth

Rick Saunders

CIA

George Tenet

Adm. Dennis Blair

STATE

Secretary Christopher

Strobe Talbott

Amb. Holbrooke

JCS

Adm. Boorda

Gen. Clark

DEFENSE

Secretary Perry

John White

Jan Lodol

NSC

Alexander Vershbow

BG Donald Kerrick

Sue Bremner

USUN

Amb. Albright

James O'Brien

WHITE HOUSE

Samuel Berger

Nancy Soderberg

Summary of Conclusions

1. Principals met August 22 to receive a debrief from Amb. Holbrooke on the recent diplomatic mission to ex-Yugoslav states. Regarding the seven key goals defined in the course of NSA Lake's earlier mission, Principals reached the following conclusions:

a) **Comprehensive nature of settlement:** We will continue to make this our overarching goal.

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b) **Three-way mutual recognition:** While Milosevic remains opposed to recognizing Croatia, we will continue to pursue this goal. It should not, however, be a prerequisite for a Bosnia settlement.

c) **Territorial adjustments:** We will retain as an eventual goal a contiguous landmass for the Bosnian Federation and press the case for defensibility with the GoBH. For the time being, however, we will not insist that the GoBH agree to give up Gorazde, so as to avoid intensifying fears we are unconcerned about the possibility of excessive, Croatian territory in Bosnia proper.

d) **Constitutional Provisions:** Discussions have only begun with the parties.

e) **Sanctions Suspension/Relief:** We will continue to try to avoid being drawn into discussions of intermediate steps. OVP will finalize its paper on when sanctions suspension (to be granted to Belgrade upon signature of a peace accord) could be turned into sanctions lift. OVP's paper should describe the stage in the settlement implementation process at which full lift would come into being.

f) **Sector East:** Although Milosevic told Amb. Holbrooke he privately accepted that Eastern Slavonia was part of Croatia, a negotiated solution will be difficult in the near term. At a minimum, we need to initiate a process based on Z-4 principles. We also need to convince Tudjman that UNCRO must remain in place in Sector East. We will continue to refine our strategy on negotiations with the aim of preventing a military confrontation that would draw in the FRY.

g) **Economic Reconstruction:** Deputies will consider the subject on a priority basis in the course of the meeting on post-settlement implementation scheduled for August 23. At issue are the nature and scope of the assistance program, the size of the U.S. contribution, how to convince Congress the plan deserves support, where the USG contribution will come from, and how much we can expect to see from the Europeans, the Japanese, and moderate Arab states. ~~(S)~~

2. On the issue of the UK decision to withdraw from Gorazde, Principals decided to avoid attempting to change UK minds at this time. ~~(S)~~

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